

Eucharistic Prayer

The Eucharist, like the manna in the desert, is bread from heaven. Blessed are we to receive such bread!



So Jesus said to them, "Amen, amen, I say to you, it was not Moses who gave the bread from heaven; my Father gives you the true bread from heaven. For the bread of God is that which comes down from heaven and gives life to the world." John 6:32-33



Spot the Difference

The manna in the desert was a foreshadowing of the Eucharist, but there are some differences between the two because the **new (the Eucharist)** fulfills the **old (manna)**. Write an N next to the phrase that pertains to the Eucharist, and an O next to the phrase that pertains to the manna. Write a **B** when the statement applies to **both**.

- | | |
|---|---|
| _____ Gathered every day but the Sabbath | _____ Must be consumed every Sabbath. |
| _____ Is the food of eternal life. | _____ Sustains the body, not the soul. |
| _____ Miraculous bread from heaven. | _____ Known as the "Bread of Angels" |
| _____ Stored in a special sanctuary. | _____ Tastes like honey. |
| _____ Can be consumed daily. | _____ Body, blood, soul, and divinity of Jesus. |
| _____ Shows up miraculously out of nothing, | _____ Is made my man, then transubstantiated. |



Did You Know?

Dew is a collection of water droplets that appear on surfaces when water vapor condenses. It often appears on grass, spider-webs, leaves of trees, and flower petals; looking like little diamonds. When the light hits dew at the right angle, a prismatic, rainbow affect can occur that is quite beautiful.

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on Spirit of God and the Eucharist.

The bread we receive in the Holy Eucharist, is literally bread from heaven, just like the miraculous manna that appeared in the desert for the Israelites. How does this affect how you experience the Mass?

“Make holy, therefore, these gifts, we pray, by sending down your spirit upon them like the dewfall”... What are some words and feelings that describe dew?

Response of Adoration

Use your reflections to guide a prayer to the saints.

Take those words you wrote to describe dew, and use them to craft a prayer of praise to the Lord. Begin like this, “God, your spirit is like the dewfall. You are...

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer with God.

Imagine you are an Israelite wandering in the desert. You are exhausted, hungry, thirsty, and your feet hurt really badly. You didn’t get any sleep last night wondering if you would survive this arduous journey. You are on the brink of losing hope, when one morning this strange food appears on the ground like dew. You’ve never seen anything like it. Someone in the crowd shouts that it’s the food of angels. You scoop some up make it into a tiny cake and eat it. It tastes like your favorite food. What does it taste like? How do you feel now that you’ve tasted it?



REFERENCES:

Broussard, Karlo. 2023. "The Eucharist as the New Manna." Catholic Answers. June 8, 2023. <https://www.catholic.com/audio/scw/the-eucharist-as-the-new-manna>.

"Dew." Britannica Kids. <https://kids.britannica.com/kids/article/dew/404107>.

Esolen, Anthony. 2020. "The Language of Prayer Is the Language of Poetry." Catholic Answers. April 7, 2020. <https://www.catholic.com/magazine/print-edition/the-language-of-prayer-is-the-language-of-poetry>.

Praem, Hugh Barbour O. 2019. "The Chaplain Is In." Catholic Answers. February 20, 2019. <https://www.catholic.com/audio/cal/cal-8424>.

